

Counting and Probability

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Preface

These exercises were assembled to accompany a Discrete Mathematics course at Calvin College.

1 Some Counting Problems

Each of these problems involves determining how many of something there are. For most, there will be too many to simply make a list and count them off, so you will need to “count without counting”. As you go along, make a list of important counting principles you are using.

1. A new company with just two employees, Sanchez and Patel, rents a floor of a building with 12 offices. How many ways are there to assign different offices to these two employees?
2. The chairs of an auditorium are labeled with a letter (indicating the row) and a positive integer not exceeding 100 (indicating the seat within the row). Give an upper bound on the number of seats in the auditorium.
3. There are 32 microcomputers in a computer center. Each microcomputer has 24 ports. How many different ports to a microcomputer in the center are there?
4. How many bitstrings of length 8 are there?
5. How many bitstrings of length 8 either start with a 1 or end with a 1?
6. A state issues license plates that consist of three letters followed by three numbers. How many such plates are there?
7. A graph isomorphism is a 1-1 and onto function from the vertices in one graph to the vertices in another (that additionally preserves edges). You decide to write a little program that will check each 1-1 and onto function to see if it an isomorphism.

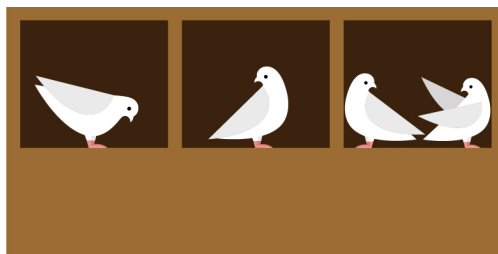
If your graphs have n vertices, how many such functions must you check?

8. Now you modify your graph isomorphism algorithm so that it only tries bijections (1-1 and onto functions) that respect the degrees of the vertices. If the degree sequences of two graphs are both $(5, 5, 4, 4, 4, 3, 3, 2)$, how many functions must you check? How much better is this than your previous algorithm (on these two graphs)?
9. Let's use the following coding scheme to describe possible telephone numbers.
 - let X denote a digit that can take on any integer value $0 - 9$;
 - let N denote a digit that can take on values $2 - 9$
 - let Y denote a digit that can only take on values 0 or 1.
 - a. In the scheme used in the 1960's, telephone numbers had to have the form NYX-NNX-XXXX. How many such phone numbers are there?
 - b. A new scheme (*The North American Numbering Plan*) was introduced that required telephone numbers have the form NXX-NXX-XXXX. How many more phone numbers are available in the new scheme?
10. How many password of length 6, 7, or 8 are there if the passwords must be alpha-numeric, capitalization doesn't matter, and there must be at least one digit?
11. In the previous example, how many passwords are there if the first character must be a letter?
12. Professor Pruim puts the names of 30 students into a hat. He draws one out and gives that person a chocolate bar. Then he draws out another name, and gives that person a bag of M and M's. Finally, he draws out a third name and gives that person a bag of Valentine hearts he picked up cheap on February 15.
 - a. How many different ways can the prizes be distributed?
 - b. If you are one of the 30 students, how many of those ways include you getting a prize?

Answers/Solutions

1. $12 * 11 = 132$.
2. $26 * 100 = 2600$
3. $32 * 24 = 768$.
4. $2^8 = 256$
5. Two ways:
 - a. only bad thing is beginning AND ending with 0, so $2^8 - 2^6 = 192$.
 - b. Start with 1 or end with 1 but not both: $2^7 + 2^7 - 2^6 = 192$
6. $10^3 \cdot 26^3 = 17576000$
7. $n!$
8. $2 \cdot 1 \cdot 3 \cdot 2 \cdot 1 \cdot 2 \cdot 1 \cdot 1 = 24$. ($8! = 40320$, so that's a pretty big speed up.)
9. See book.
10. $36^6 - 26^6 + 36^7 - 26^7 + 36^8 - 26^8 = 2684483063360$
11. $26 * (36^5 - 26^5) + 26 * (36^6 - 26^6) + 26 * (36^7 - 26^7) = 1878468937280$
12. a. $30 * 29 * 28 = 24360$
b. $1 * 29 * 28 + 29 * 1 * 28 + 29 * 28 * 1 = 30 * 29 * 28 - 29 * 28 * 27 = 2436$

2 Pigeonhole Principle



Big Idea: It is not possible for everyone to be above average or for everyone to be below average. (It is possible for everyone to be exactly average.)

So if n things are distributed into k groups,

- The largest group will have at least $\lceil n/k \rceil$ things, and
- The smallest group will have at most $\lfloor n/k \rfloor$ things.

This is called the (generalized) pigeon hole principle based on the analogy of putting letters into mail slots (called pigeon holes).

Applying the pigeonhole principle is generally easy *once you figure out what the pigeons (letters, really) and the pigeonholes are*. Figuring out the pigeons and holes can be easy, or it can take a clever idea. (Some famous proofs center on very clever uses of the pigeonhole principle.)

1. Suppose (in some alternative reality) that Professor Pruim brought 150 cookies to a class with 34 students. At the end of the hour, all of the cookies had been eaten by the students.
 - a. What is the average number of cookies eaten by a student?
 - b. This means the at least one student had at least _____ cookies.
 - c. This means the at least one student had at most _____ cookies.

In each of the following problems, each time you use the pigeonhole principle, identify the “pigeons” and the “holes” and explain how that solves the problem. If you don’t use the pigeonhole principle directly, be sure to explain your reasoning carefully.

2. Fill in the blanks.
 - a. In a class of 38 students, there are always at least _____ students who were born in the same month.
 - b. In a class of 38 students, there are always at least _____ students who were born on the same day of the week.
3. In the 2014 Winter Olympics, 88 nations competed in 98 events. Explain how this guaranteed that some country would win more than one gold medal. (No, the answer is not “Norway was there.”)
4. At the 2014 Winter Olympics, Norway won 11 gold medals. Does that fact alone guarantee that a country won no gold medals?

5. Joe has 21 white socks and 15 black socks. (Don't ask what happened to the missing socks, no one knows where they go.)
 - a. If he pulls socks in the dark (so he can't tell what color they are), how many must he grab to make sure he has a pair of white socks?
 - b. If he pulls socks in the dark (so he can't tell what color they are), how many must he grab to make sure he has a pair of black socks?
 - c. If he pulls socks in the dark (so he can't tell what color they are), how many must he grab to make sure he has a pair of matching socks?
6. For his birthday, Joe received a gift of 8 red socks (4 pairs, and he hasn't lost any yet). Now how many socks must Joe grab to be sure that he has a matching pair?
7. Joe is going on a trip and needs 3 pairs of matching socks. He's still too lazy to turn on the light to see what socks he is grabbing. How many socks must Joe bring along to make sure he has 3 matching pairs? (He doesn't care how many pairs are red, white, or black.)
8. Checkers.
 - a. Consider a 3×9 grid (like an odd-shaped checker board). Show that no matter how you place red and black checkers on the 27 squares, there will always be a rectangle whose 4 corners have the same color checker. (The rectangles must be at least 2×2 ; 1×1 rectangles don't have four different checkers on their corners.)
 - b. Consider a 3×7 grid (like an odd-shaped checker board). Show that no matter how you place red and black checkers on the 21 squares, there will always be a rectangle whose 4 corners have the same color checker. (The rectangles must be at least 2×2 ; 1×1 rectangles don't have four different checkers on their corners.)
 - c. Show how to place red and black checkers on a 3×6 grid without having any rectangles with mono-chromatic corners.
9. Show that there is an integer that is divisible by 37 and consists only of 1's and 0's in its decimal representation.
 Hint: Consider the numbers 1, 11, 111, 1111, 11111, etc. Show that two of them are congruent mod 37. How does that help you answer the question?
10. Was there anything special about the number 37 in the previous example? For what other divisors does this work? Explain.
11. Is there anything special about the digits 1 and 0 in the previous example? What other combinations of digits would work?
12. A computer lab has 15 workstations and 10 servers. Workstations can only access servers via direct connections, and each server can only use one of these connections at a time.
 - a. If we connect every workstation to every server, how many connections is that?
 - b. Show that 60 connections suffice make it possible to use any set of 10 workstations simultaneously. (No matter what we do, we won't be able to connect 11 workstations to servers since there are only 10 servers.)
 - c. Show that 59 connections is not enough.
 That is, no matter how you do the connecting, there will always be a combination of 10 workstations that cannot simultaneously connect to servers. (Hint: on average, how many connections are there per server?)
13. The integers from 1 to 10 are distributed around a circle. Prove that there must be three neighbors whose sum is at least 17. What about 18? What about 19?

3 Division Principle

3.1 A problem about cookies

1. Suppose 100 cookies are distributed equally to a group of kids. Each kid receives 4 cookies. How many kids are there?

3.2 The Division Principle

The reasoning used to solve the previous problem is called the division principle: If you count each item the same number of times, you can divide the count by the number of times each item is counted to get the number of items.

We have actually seen this before:

2. If the total degree of a graph is 58, how many edges does it have?

When we count the degrees, we count each edge twice, so there are $\frac{58}{2} = 29$ edges in the graph.

3.3 More Counting Problems

Here are some additional problems that involve our counting principles, including the division principle.

3. An NBA basketball team has 12 players.
 - a. How many ways can the coach select the five players to start the game? (Positions don't matter.)
 - b. How many ways can the coach select one center, two forwards, and two guards? (That is, the positions matter.)
4. How many 5-card poker hands can be dealt from a standard 52-card deck?
5. A class of 36 gets into groups of 4 to work on some problems.
 - a. How many such groups of 4 are there?
 - b. You get to work with 3 other people. How many such groups of 3 are there?
6. How many bit strings of length 8 have exactly three 1's?
7. How many "words" can you make with the letters in MISSISSIPPI? (The "words" do not need to be real words.)

4 Counting Problems

4.1 Donut problems

The problems below all involved donuts and that numbers 3 and 12. But you will need to know more than that to answer them.

1. Danielle's Donuts sells 12 kinds of donuts. This week they are offering a special: The Mighty Mixer. You get three donuts of three different kinds for \$1.99. How many different Might Mixer orders are there?
2. Debra has purchased a Mighty Mixer consisting of one sprinkle donut, one jelly-filled donut, and one pumpkin spice donut. She decides to give them away to some of her friends. She has twelve friends.
 - a. How many different ways can she give away the donuts if no one gets more than one?
 - b. How many different ways can she give away the donuts if she allow the possibility of giving more than one to the same person?
3. Don's Donuts sells 3 kinds of donuts: plain, chocolate covered, and glazed. You decide to order a different dozen (12) every week until you have ordered every possible dozen. How many weeks will that take?
4. What are the key features that make these situations different from each other? Can you work out a general formula for each of the situations?
5. Write an additional problem of each type (and work out the answer). Do not use the numbers 3 or 12 in your problems. Do not use donuts.

4.2 More Problems

As you do these problems, identify where you are using our counting principles: Multiplication Principle, Addition Principle, Subtraction Principle, Division Principle, Inclusion-Exclusion Principle, Pigeonhole Principle. For problems in the "Donut Family", identify which of the four situations the problem represents.

6. How many bit strings of length eight either start with a 1 bit or end with the two bits 00?
7. How many different ways are there to seat four people around a circular table, where two seatings are considered the same when each person has the same left neighbor and the same right neighbor?
8. A computer company receives 350 applications from computer graduates for a job planning a line of new Web servers. Suppose that 220 of these applicants majored in computer science, 147 majored in business, and 51 majored both in computer science and in business. How many of these applicants majored neither in computer science nor in business?
9. These questions involve a standard deck of cards (52 cards, 13 each are hearts, diamonds, clubs, and spades).
 - a. How many cards must be selected to guarantee that at least three of the cards are the same suit?
 - b. How many must be selected to guarantee that at least three hearts are selected?
10. What is the least number of area codes needed to guarantee that the 25 million phones in a state can be assigned distinct 10-digit telephone numbers? How many additional phones can be accommodated before needing to add another area code? (Assume that telephone numbers are of the form NXX-NXX-XXXX, where the first three digits form the area code, N represents a digit from 2 to 9 inclusive, and X represents any digit.)
11. Assume that in a group of six people, each pair of individuals consists of two friends or two enemies. Show that there are either three mutual friends or three mutual enemies in the group.

12. Suppose that there are 9 faculty members in the mathematics department and 11 in the computer science department. How many ways are there to select a committee to develop a discrete mathematics course at a school if the committee is to consist of three faculty members from the mathematics department and four from the computer science department?